BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

9 October 2026

US Communications Infrastructure

The Bernstein Data Center Atlas: An interactive, in-depth, virtual data center walk through


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Data centers and AI infrastructure are 2026's hottest topic, and they're not going away anytime soon. Investors spend every waking hour hunting the next shortage, bottleneck or sleeper component. The megabuild has dragged generalists into corners of the value chain that used to belong to specialists: switchgear, CDUs, HBM, optics, the list goes on… so who is actually doing what? And what does half this stuff even do?

INTRODUCING: THE BERNSTEIN DATA CENTER ATLAS

The Atlas is an interactive walk through a representative U.S. AI data center. Start outside the fence, where the power lines come in. Walk the corridor, step into the data hall and crack open a rack. Keep going, past the server and into the GPU package, down to the memory sitting next to the chip. Then head back out through the network, the meet-me room and the fiber leaving the building. Last stop is the businesses that fill the place and how they get paid. Click any component to see what it does, who builds it and which Bernstein analyst covers them.

As we've said many times, no single seat can understand this whole picture. (See our joint data center forecast here). The Atlas brings together 26 Bernstein analysts across infrastructure, semis, hardware, networking, electrical equipment, capital goods, energy, software, internet, telecom, digital assets and building materials, in the U.S., Europe and Asia. About 400 companies (covered, not covered and private) show up on its cards.

WHAT'S INSIDE

It starts before the first shovel: land, steel and concrete, then the grid and the interconnection queue that decides when a site actually switches on. Inside the fence, the power room tames the electricity and the cooling plant figures out where all that heat goes. The data hall is where the hardware lives, and from there you can zoom from a rack to a server to the chip itself. The networking and meet-me rooms show how data moves around the cluster and out to the world. And the finale answers the question that pays for all of it: who fills the building, whether that's cloud, colocation or the software riding on top.

HOW TO USE IT

Are you a newbie? Take the full tour: 18 stops, one short explainer at each. More seasoned? Dive right in, click any door or search for a company, ticker or term. Every card shows what a part does and who makes it, linked to the Bernstein analyst who covers it. Our analysts are standing in the rooms they cover, so click one to land on their coverage (and let us know if they don't look like their avatars). Each room also contains our sector views; and the glossary is on hand when things start to get confusing.

And yes, this virtual data center was built in a very real AI data center. Like the rest of the market, our value per token is still TBD.

First Published: 09 Oct 2026 04:01 UTC Completion Date: 08 Oct 2026 21:47 UTC

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	8 Oct 2026 Closing Price	Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	Adjusted P/E (x) 2025A	2026E	2027E
EQIX (Equinix)	O	USD	1,011.16	1,270.00	10.8%	USD	14.96	17.12	20.13	67.6	59.1	50.2
DLR (Digital Realty)	O	USD	176.07	226.00	(13.9)%	USD	3.87	3.09	3.21	45.5	56.9	54.9
CSQR (Csquare)	O	USD	17.38	27.00	NA	USD	0.00	(1.34)	(1.06)		(12.9)	(16.4)
BXDC (Blackstone Digital Infra)	O	USD	16.86	26.00	NA	USD	0.00	0.32	(1.00)		52.9	(16.8)
SPX			7,765.36									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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We hope you find our atlas as fun as we do.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY

Equinix, Inc.

We value EQIX on a forward Price-to-Adjusted Funds From Operations (AFFO) multiple. Our $1,270 price target is based on ~25x NTM+1 AFFO of $5.04B.

Digital Realty Trust, Inc.

We value DLR on a forward Price-to-Adjusted Funds From Operations (AFFO) per share multiple. Our $226 price target is based on 27x our NTM+1 AFFO per share of $8.36.

Csquare, Inc.

We value Csquare, Inc. on an EV/Adj. EBITDA basis, using a multiple of 15x on NTM+1 Adj. EBITDA of $568M.

Blackstone Digital Infrastructure Trust Inc.

We value BXDC on an NTM+1 AFFO basis using a 22x P/AFFO multiple, for a target price of $26.

RISKS

Equinix, Inc.

The main downside risks to our price target/Outperform rating on EQIX are 1) Slowdown in enterprise demand for data center capacity, 2) Increased competition in the interconnection space, and 3) Continuing decline in market share of data center supply may elevate pricing pressures

Digital Realty Trust, Inc.

The main downside risks to our price target/Outperform rating on DLR are 1) Lower than expected growth in the <1MW segment, 2) Slowdown in enterprise demand for data center capacity, and 3) Continuing decline in market share of data center supply may elevate pricing pressures

Csquare, Inc.

The main downside risks to our CSQR price target are 1) Deleveraging takes longer than expected, 2) execution risk associated with unlocking incremental capacity, and 3) Brookfield retains board control and majority vote.

Blackstone Digital Infrastructure Trust Inc.

The main downside risks to our BXDC price target are 1) execution risk associated with blind pool structure, 2) conflicts of interest with other Blackstone vehicles that may compete for the same assets, and 3) cap rate compression over time as “copycat” vehicles spring up.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

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The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/-15 pp
- Underperform: Stock will trail the performance of the market index by more than 15 pp

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Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

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The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

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- Credit Underperform (C-UP): The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to underperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

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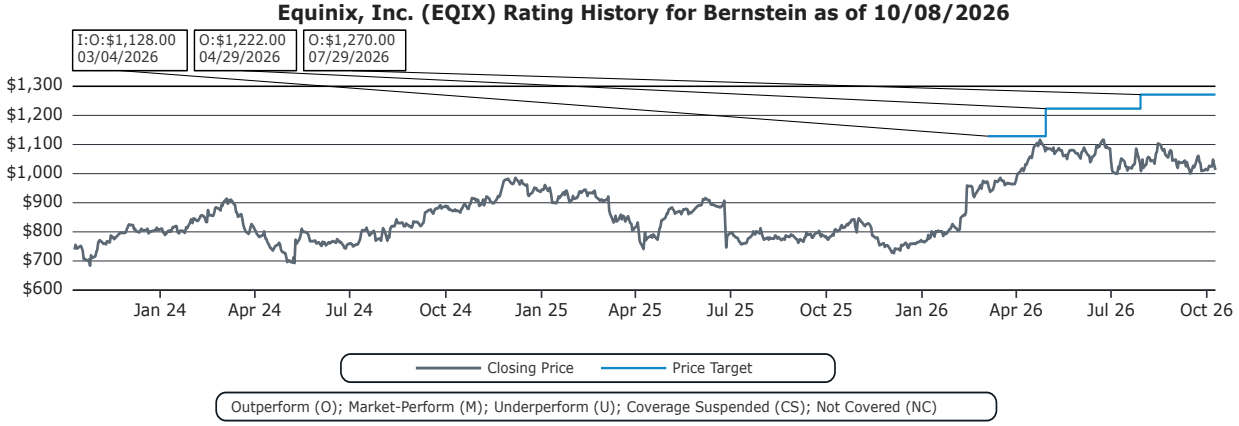
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Equity Rating	Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) and FINRA Rating Category	Global Rating Distribution	Investment Banking Relationships*
Outperform	BUY	52.3%	14.2%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.6%	16.1%
Underperform	SELL	12.1%	13.6%

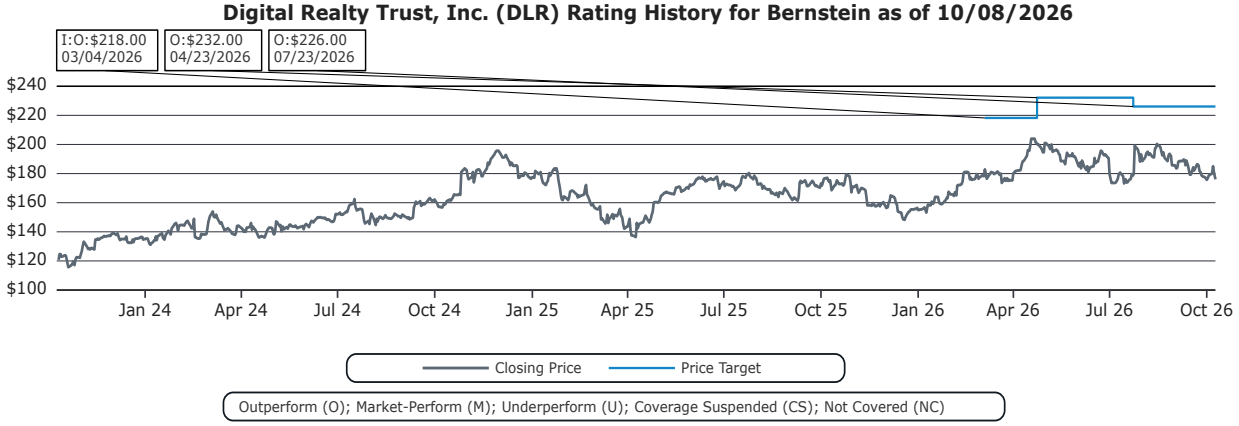
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As of September 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

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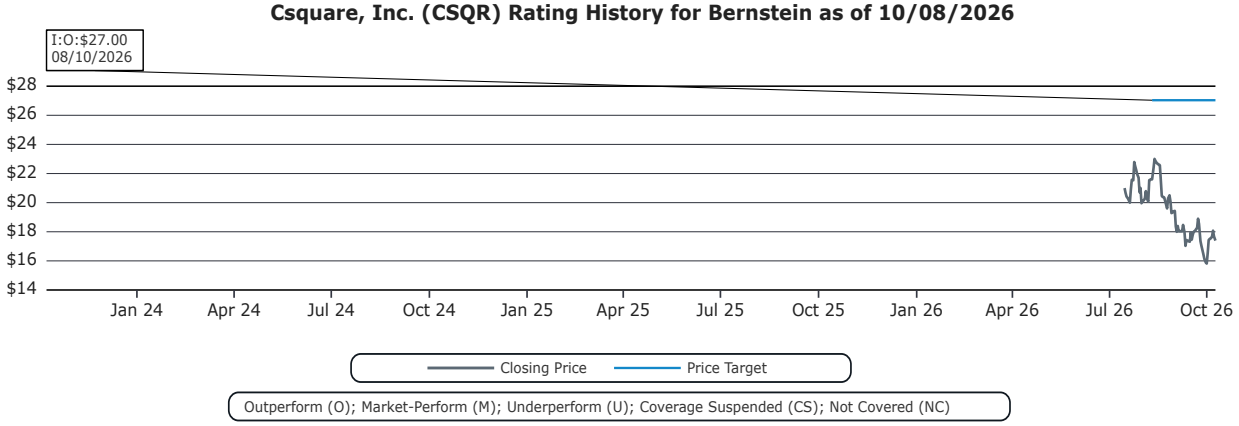
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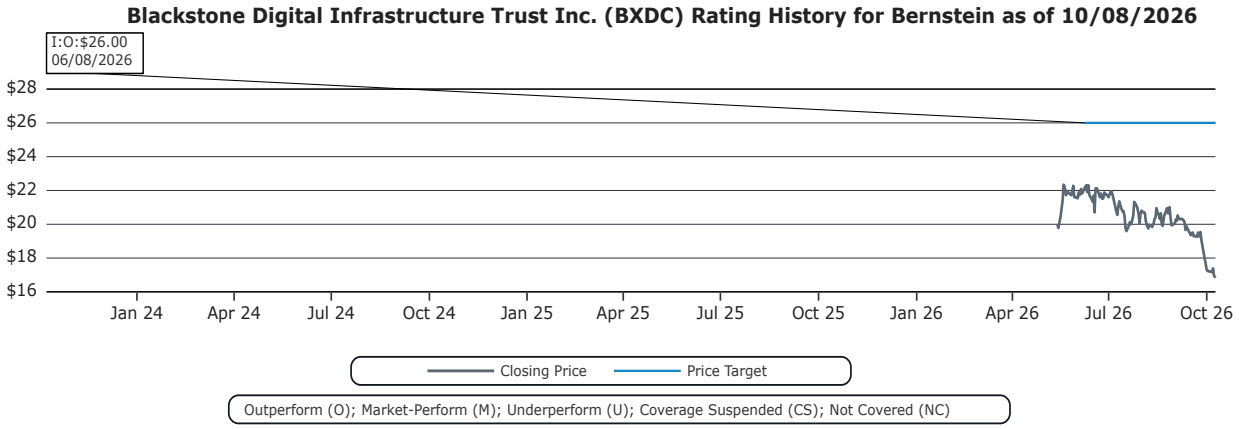


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